moved to the South. I do think at times that Israel engages in such massive destruction because it is the most obvious way of getting at Hamas's tunnels and their concealment behind civilian structures. The pity of it all!

The transfer of ten adult female hostages has started. The head of the CIA, the head of Mossad, and the head of Egyptian intelligence are all in Doha to discuss turning the partial truce into a permanent ceasefire that would allow the return of all hostages.

The cabinet is meeting. I guess that they will decide to agree to prolong the truce and a return of as many hostages as possible. This is probably the American wish.

*Wednesday, November 29*

It seems that the truce will be prolonged by several more days. In the meantime, hostages are being liberated and so are Palestinian prisoners. Humanitarian aid is rushed into Gaza. In other terms, the US is setting the tone.

Horrible news: the Bibes family hostages, a baby of ten months, a boy of four, and their mother, cannot be released: they are dead, says Hamas. It may be psychological terror, as there is no proof. The IDF tries to find out.

Nine-year-old Emily Hand, who was also taken hostage on October 7, was released after fifty days. According to her father, Emily now speaks only in whispers. The little girl can no longer speak otherwise.

Secretary of State Blinken is in Israel once more. It is probable that the truce will be prolongated for a few days. Netanyahu declares that the fighting will resume after the release of the hostages and that that is also the cabinet's position. Sure, but it is probably not President Biden's idea. Actually, American officials are warning Israel about the scope of further fighting in the South of the enclave.